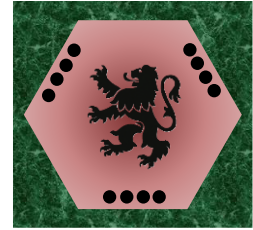


Land of Barons



1. The Essentials

Land of Barons is a deterministic territorial control and tempo management game. Designed as an uncompromising **2-player strategic duel**, it expands into an **epic struggle** for influence with **3 or 4 players**. Featuring zero randomness, you will use your **deck of cards** as a true council of war to deploy your **Troops**, build **Fiefs**, and corner your opponents. The game ends in an immediate victory if a player establishes their **Supremacy** (18 points in a duel), or with a final territory scoring if the **Exhaustion** of forces or **Bankruptcy** precipitates the end of hostilities



2. General Information

Number of Players	2 to 4
Age	10
Duration	60 minutes
Experience Level	Intermediate Players

Genre
Conquest
Tactical
Logistics

Mechanics
Area Control
Chain of Command
Hand Management



The Land of Barons, Game rules for 2 to 4 players.

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3. Lore: Govern and Build

In Land of Barons, the conquest of Fiefs is achieved through rigorous and bold planning. Your strategy is forged in utmost secrecy: using a deck of cards to dictate your orders, you assemble a true council of war—the nerve center of your chain of command. This council dictates every maneuver of your Baron and his powerful Knights, who alone can hinder your opponents' actions. Together, they lead your Troops across a battlefield that is unique to every game. They stand ready

to fight or build—establishing new Fiefs or annexing rival ones—in purely deterministic clashes where only your tactical superiority will prevail.

The secrecy of enemy intentions and the mastery of tempo, constrained by your limited command resources, instill a palpable psychological tension around the table. Why does that opponent keep raising Troops instead of establishing a Fief? Are they waiting for the perfect moment? Are they preparing to annex the territory you just built? It is up to you to see through their feints and choose the precise time and place to strike, defend, or build.

Your assaults take a physical and moral toll on your men, forcing you to temporarily demobilize your Troops. However, establishing your Fiefs demands an even greater sacrifice: your Troops must permanently lay down their arms to durably build your new lands, depriving you of your vital forces. Resolving these dilemmas requires bold choices within a relentless race for supremacy, before the Exhaustion of your forces or the sudden Bankruptcy of your treasury freezes the borders and triggers the final scoring.

Orchestrating this fragile balance between military deployment, territorial administration, and treasury management will be your greatest challenge. Will you impose your authority to become the first among Barons and secure your reign?

Contents

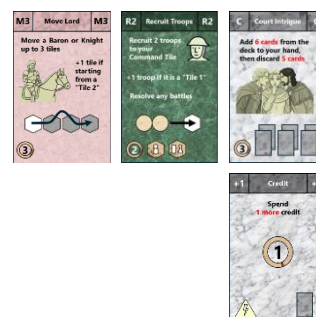
1. The Essentials	1
2. General Information	1
3. Lore: Govern and Build.....	1
4. Components	3
5. Goal of the Game – Game End – Winner.....	4
5.1. Goal of the Game.....	4
5.2. Game End	4
5.3. Determining the Winner	5
5.4. Scoring Examples	5
6. Setup	6
6.1. Shaping the Terrain	6
6.2. Initial Deployment	6
6.3. Preparation of the Lords.....	7
6.4. Table Layout.....	7
7. Turn Sequence	8
8. Managing the Deck and Discard Pile.....	9
9. Action Card Effects.....	10
9.1. Lord Action Cards	11
9.2. Combat – Control – Command	12
9.2.1. Clash Resolution	12
9.2.2. Controlling a Tile	13

9.2.3.	Command Tile	14
9.3.	Troop Action Cards	15
9.4.	Hand Action Cards.....	18
10.	The Effect Cards	18
11.	Reference Sheet	20

Statistics: 20 pages; 3 992 words; 19 013 characters.

4. Components

- **37 Hexagonal Tiles:** Double-sided. Front: Lands worth 1, 2, 3, or 4 points. Back: Impassable Mountains (solid brown face). Each tile is identifiable on the front by a color, a crest, and a letter, distributed as follows:
 - 10 Red 4-point Tiles (Lion crest)
 - 9 Blue 3-point Tiles (Eagle crest)
 - 9 Green 2-point Tiles (Wolf crest)
 - 9 Grey 1-point Tiles (Horse crest)
- **37 Position Cards:** Matching the colors, letters, and crests of the Tiles.
- **4 Prestige Cubes:** 1 white cube for the **Free City** and 3 wooden cubes for the **Trading Cities**.
- **1 Score Track**
- **Player Materials (x4 sets):**
 - 1 Large **Baron Pawn**
 - 4 Small **Knight Pawns**
 - 30 **Troop Tokens**
 - 10 Small Cylindrical **Keeps**
 - 1 Deck of 43 **Action cards** (pink, green and grey) and 3 **Effect cards** (gray with a lightning bolt in the bottom left corner).



5. Goal of the Game – Game End – Winner

5.1. Goal of the Game

Your goal is to accumulate the most points by asserting your dominance through the establishment of **Fiefs**. Your total score is the sum of three types of points:

1. **Fief Points:** The value of each Land where you control a **Keep**.
2. **Prestige Points:** Bonuses awarded if your Fiefs include the Free City or Merchant Cities.
3. **Diversity Points:** A bonus rewarding the variety of coats of arms (= Land colors) conquered.

Fief Points		Prestige Points		Diversity Points	
Grey Land (Horse)	1 point	Trading City	2 points	2 colors	2 points
Green Land (Wolf)	2 points	Free City	4 points	3 colors	3 points
Blue Land (Eagle)	3 points			4 colors	4 points
Red Land (Lion)	4 points				

Important Note: The **score track** monitors scores in **real-time**. Update it at the end of each player's turn whenever Keeps are built or destroyed. **No points are permanent:** scores depend solely on the current state of the board. If a Keep is removed, all associated gains are instantly lost: **Fief Points**, **Prestige Points**, and even the **Diversity bonus**, which must be recalculated based on your remaining Land colors.

5.2. Game End

The game ends immediately at the end of the active player's turn if any of the following **three conditions** are met:

- **Supremacy:** The active player reaches or exceeds the **Critical Point Threshold**. *Their influence is so great that their rivals have no choice but to bend the knee.*
- **Exhaustion:** The active player has **5 or fewer Troops** remaining (total on the board and in their supply). *Too much blood has been shed, and the heralds sound the end of the conflict.*
- **Bankruptcy:** The active player has 0 cards left in hand. *The clash of arms fades before negotiations, freezing the Barons' positions.*

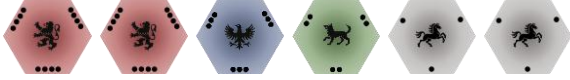
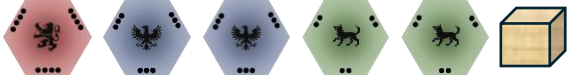
Critical Thresholds			
Configuration	Supremacy	Exhaustion	Bankruptcy
2-Player Game	18 points	5 Troops	0 card in hand
3-Player Game	14 points	5 Troops	0 card in hand
4-Player Game	12 points	5 Troops	0 card in hand

5.3. Determining the Winner

Once the end of the game is triggered, the player with the **highest score** wins. In the event of a tie, the following tie-breakers are used in order:

1. **Most Keeps/ Fiefs** on the board.
2. **Most Troops** available (total on the board and in the supply).
3. If the tie persists, the players **share the victory!**

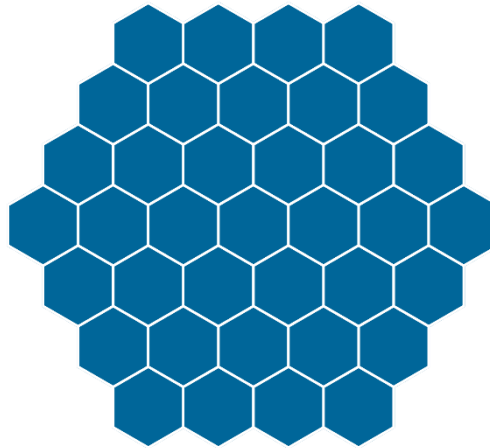
5.4. Scoring Examples

Conquests	Land Points	Prestige	Diversity	Total
	$4+4+4+4 = 16$	4	0	20
	$4+4+3+3 = 14$	$2+2=4$	2	20
	$4+4+3+2+1 + 1 = 15$	0	4	19
	$4+3+3+2+2 = 14$	2	3	19

6. Setup

6.1. Shaping the Terrain

- **The Board** – Shuffle the **Tiles** and arrange them with the "crest" side visible following the hexagonal pattern below (a large hexagon with 4 tiles per side).



- **Special Positions** – Shuffle the 37 **Position cards**. For each step below, announce the element, draw a card, and place the element on the corresponding Tile:
 - **Mountains:** Draw **4 cards**. Flip the designated Tiles to their brown side (crests hidden).
Important: Permanently remove these 4 cards from the game.
 - **Free City:** Draw **1 card** and place the **white cube** on the designated Tile.
 - **Trading Cities:** Draw **3 cards** and place the **wooden cubes** on the designated Tiles.

6.2. Initial Deployment

Before players choose their sides, draw the starting **Positions** for each color in play:

- **One Tile** for the **Baron**.
- **One Tile** for the **first Knight**.
- **One Tile** for the **second Knight**.

Important: Permanently remove any **Position card** from the game after it is drawn.

Vigilance (Blocking and Balance)

- **Accessibility:** If a Baron, a Knight, the Free City, or a Trading City is isolated from the rest of the board by Mountains, redraw its Position card.
- **Connectivity:** If the terrain is too fragmented or if Tile colors are too clustered (creating unbalanced zones), players are encouraged to perform a full reshuffle of the board.

6.3. Preparation of the Lords

- **Turn Order** – Play proceeds clockwise. To determine the first player, each player draws one Position card. The first player is the one with the **lowest-ranked card** based on the following hierarchy:
 - **Crest Value:** Horse (1) < Wolf (2) < Eagle (3) < Lion (4).
 - **Letter:** A < B < C < D...

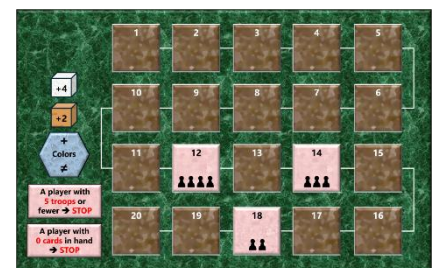
Examples: A Wolf card (2) plays before a Lion card (4). Between two Wolf cards, Wolf "A" plays before Wolf "B".
- **Choosing Colors** – Starting with the **last player** and moving counter-clockwise, each player chooses a color and collects their materials.
- **Supply Setup** – Each player places the following in front of them:
 - Their **Liege Knights** (2 in the supply; the other 2 already on the board).
 - **10 Keeps** and **30 Troops**.
- **The Deck** – Shuffle your **43 Action cards** and your **3 Effect cards** to form your face-down deck
- **The Barons' Oath (Simultaneous Mulligan)** – Before the first player opens hostilities, all players proceed simultaneously:
 - **Draw** an initial hand of **6 cards**.
 - **Decision:** If you are unsatisfied with your hand, you may take a single **free Mulligan**.
 - **Procedure:** Return your 6 cards to your deck, reshuffle, and draw your final hand of 6 cards. *Once all Lords have sworn an oath upon their hand, the conquest begins!*

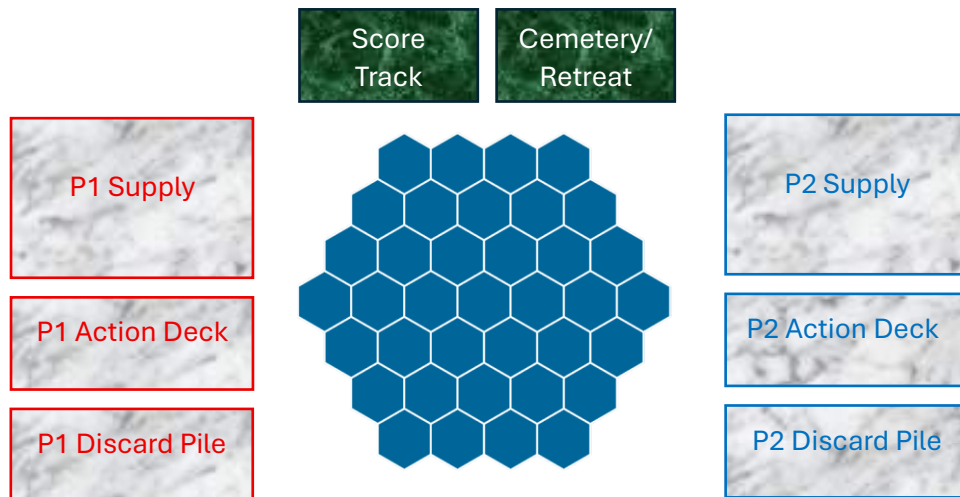
6.4. Table Layout

- **Cemetery/Retreat:** Designate a shared space (e.g., the box lid) for all **Troops** permanently leaving the game (due to combat or construction).
- **Score Track:** Place the track where everyone can see it. Each player places one **Keep** in front of the "1" space to mark their starting influence.

The conquest begins! The **first player** opens hostilities, followed by the other players in **clockwise order**.

Below is the table layout diagram for a 2-player game



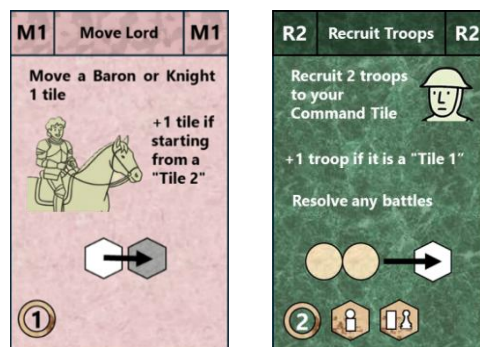


7. Turn Sequence

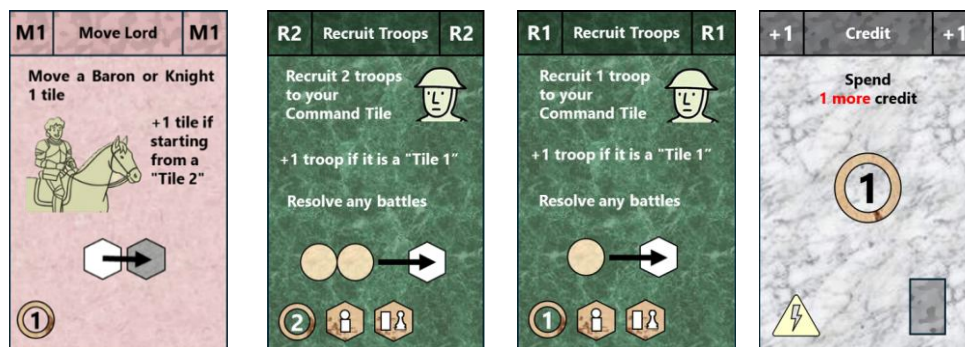
On your turn, you must choose **one** of the following two options:

Option A — Take Action

1. **Plan** – From your hand, choose **at least 1 Action card** and, optionally, one or more **Effect cards**.
 - Effect cards (with a lightning bolt in the bottom left) have a cost of 0.
 - The **total cost of the Action cards** (indicated in the bottom left) must not exceed the amount of credits available for your turn. This amount is **3 credits by default**, but can exceptionally increase to 4 if you play the "+1 Credit" Effect card.



Example: Playing 2 cards with costs of 1 + 2 = 3 credits



Example! Playing 3 cards with costs of 1+2+1 = 4 credits

2. **Act** – Execute the instructions of the chosen cards following these rules:

- **Free Order and Association:** You choose the sequence in which you resolve your cards. Effect cards are used in different ways: some act independently (such as "+1 Credit"), others must be explicitly paired with an Action card to modify its effect. It is possible to associate multiple compatible Effect cards with a single Action card. In all cases, an Effect card is single-use and fully consumed upon resolution (see §10 for details).
- **Independence:** Each played element (an Action card with its potential Effects, or an independently acting Effect card) must be resolved fully before moving to the next. A resolution may alter the board state, thus influencing the conditions for subsequent elements played during the same turn.
- **Discard:** Once played, place your cards face-up in your **personal Discard Pile**.

3. **Reinforce** – Refill your hand to **6 cards**, or until your final deck is empty.

4. **Refresh (End of Turn)**

- Update the **Score Track** based on the final state of the board.
- Check if a threshold for **Supremacy** (points), **Exhaustion** (remaining troops), or **Bankruptcy** threshold has been reached. If so, the game ends immediately.

Option B — Replan

If you choose **not** to play any Action cards:

1. **Purge:** Discard **between 1 and 6 cards** from your hand to your **personal Discard Pile**.
2. **Renew** – Refill your hand to **6 cards**, or until your final deck is empty.
3. **Refresh (End of Turn)** – As with Option A, update the **score** and check the game-end conditions. Typically, if your now-empty hand triggers a game end via Bankruptcy

8. Managing the Deck and Discard Pile

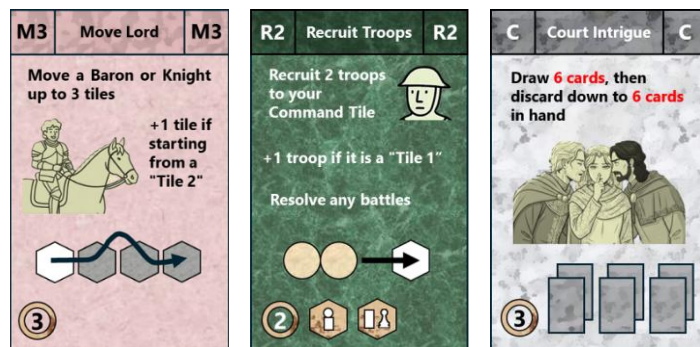
- **Transparency:** Your opponents may ask to examine the cards you have just discarded during your turn. Once the examination is complete, only the top card of the pile remains visible.
- **Confidentiality:** Aside from this immediate consultation, the contents of the discard piles are secret. No player may browse their own discard pile or that of a rival.
- **Deck Cycling:** As soon as your deck is empty and you still need to draw cards to refill your hand:
 1. First, draw the remaining cards from your deck, if any.
 2. Shuffle the cards in **your discard pile**.
 3. This forms your **new** and **final deck**.
 4. Take the **top 6 cards** of your deck. These cards are set aside, face down, to form your **Reserve**. The rest of the cards constitute your **main draw pile**:

- Draw from your main draw pile.
 - When it is empty, spread the 6 cards of your **Reserve** face down in front of you, acting as a visual countdown.
 - From now on, you draw from your Reserve.
5. Finish refilling your hand.

9. Action Card Effects

Action cards are divided into three types, identified by their background color, as shown in the figure below:

- **Pink Background:** Lord Actions (Baron or Knight).
- **Green Background:** Troop Actions.
- **Grey Background:** Action on your hand or an opponent's hand.



The following table provides a summary of the 43 Action cards.

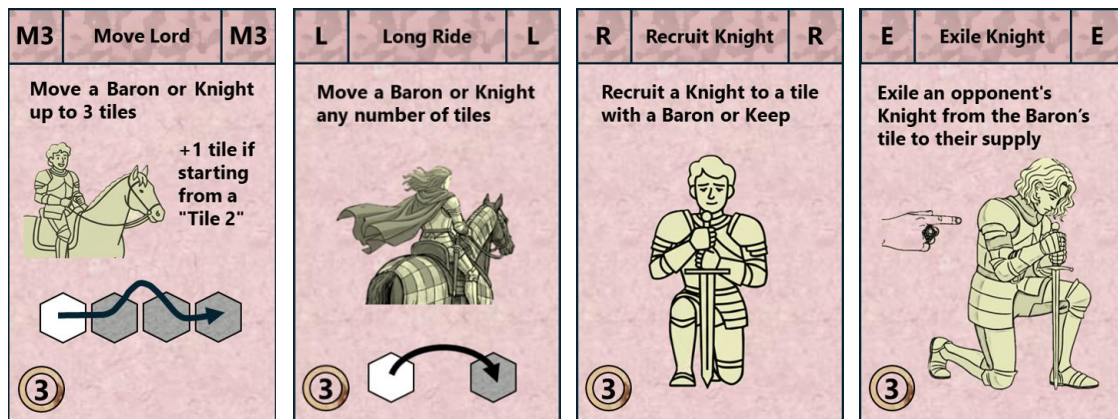
Action Card	Credits	Quantity	Groups			43
Move Lord 3	3	4	15			
Move Lord 2	2	5				
Move Lord 1	1	6				
Recruit Troops 3	3	2	9	17	23	
Recruit Troops 2	2	3				
Recruit Troops 1	1	4				
Concentrate Troops	1	3	8			
Disperse Troops	1	5				
Build Keep	3	6	6	6		
Long Ride	3	1	5			
Recruit Knight	3	1				
Exile Knight	3	1				
Court Intrigue	3	1				
Spy	2	1				

For each card, its name, type (via background color), cost, and quantity are listed.

Action cards are described in detail by type in the following sections.

9.1. Lord Action Cards

Below are the effects of Action cards played on a Lord.



- **Move Lord 3** – Move one Lord (Baron or Knight) up to **3 Tiles**. The movement does not have to be in a straight line.
 - **Bonus:** If your Lord starts their movement on a **2-point Tile (Wolf)**, they gain **+1 Movement** (*representing a lush green land where they can regain their strength*).
 - **Constraints:**
 - ✓ A **Baron** or a **Knight** may not pass through or occupy a **Mountain Tile**.
 - ✓ A **Knight** has no other passing or occupying restrictions.
 - ✓ A **Baron** may **not occupy** a Tile occupied by an **enemy Baron** or an **enemy Keep**. However, a **Baron** may pass through such a Tile.
 - ✓ A **Baron** may pass through and occupy a Tile occupied by friendly or enemy Troops and Knights.
- **Move Lord 2** – Identical to "Move Lord 3," but with a maximum distance of **2 Tiles** (plus any potential terrain bonus).
- **Move Lord 1** – Identical to "Move Lord 3," but with a maximum distance of **1 Tile** (plus any potential terrain bonus).
- **Long Ride (Rare)** – Choose one Lord (Baron or Knight) currently on the board and move them directly to **any Tile of your choice**, respecting the occupation restrictions listed under "Move Lord 3."
- **Recruit Knight (Rare)** – If you have a Knight remaining in your supply, place that Knight directly onto a Tile occupied by your **Baron** or one of your **Keeps**.
- **Exile Knight (Rare)** – If an **enemy Knight** is present on the same Tile as your **Baron**, that Knight is sent back to the **opponent's supply**. If multiple enemy Knights are on your Baron's Tile, this effect **only** applies to **one** of them.

9.2. Combat – Control – Command

Before describing the **Troop Action cards** in §9.3, three key mechanics must be detailed:

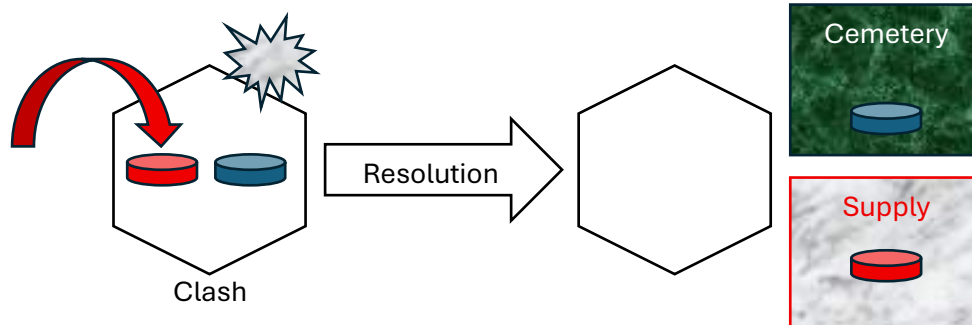
- **Clash Resolution:** Resolving "Troops vs. Troops" and "Troops vs. Keep" encounters.
- **Knight Control:** How Knights lock down a Tile.
- **Troop Command:** Issuing orders to Troops from a Tile.

9.2.1. Clash Resolution

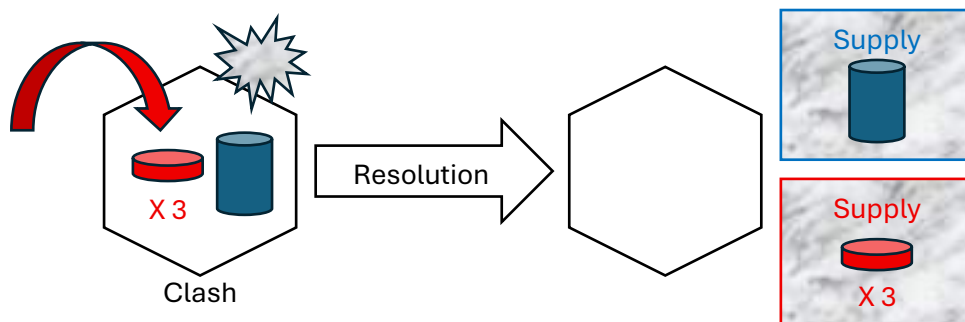
Clashes occur in the following situations. Resolving each clash is **mandatory and immediate**.

The Vanguard Rule – When performing a **Concentrate** or **Disperse** action, you may freely organize your engaged Troops into **multiple Assaults**. For each Assault, only the specific number of Troops necessary to resolve the combat (the **Vanguard**) is used. It is the number of attacking Troops present on the Tile **at the conclusion of an individual Assault** that determines the effect triggered on a Keep (Destruction or Capture)

- **Troop Clash** – On a Tile occupied by enemy Troops, the arrival of one or more of your Troops triggers a clash:

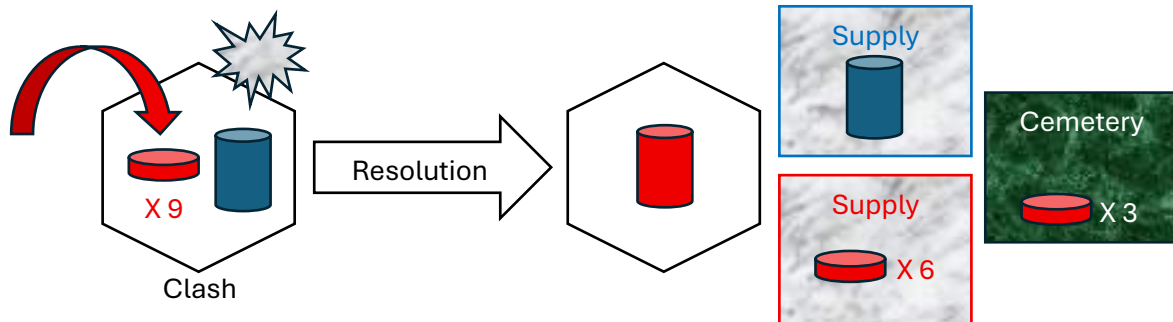


- The principle is: **1 Troop versus 1 Troop**.
 - Your **Troop** is the **attacker**. It is returned to your **Supply**.
 - The enemy **Troop** is the one being **attacked**. It is sent to the **Cemetery**.
 - Resolving **Troop Clashes** takes **priority over Keep Clashes** (see Keep Destruction or Capture).
- **Keep Destruction** – On a Tile occupied by an enemy Keep, the presence of your Troops may trigger a clash:



- The principle is: **3 Troops versus 1 Keep**.

- If, at the conclusion of an individual Assault, the presence of your **attacking Troops** is **equal to or greater than 3** (without reaching the Capture threshold), the **Destruction** clash is triggered.
- The **enemy Keep** is destroyed and returned to its owner's **Supply**.
- Your **3 attacking Troops** are returned to your **Supply**.
- **Keep Capture** – This is a powerful variation of "Keep Destruction»:



- The principle is: **9 Troops versus 1 Keep + 1 Keep**.
- If, at the conclusion of an individual Assault, the presence of your **attacking Troops** is **equal to or greater than 9**, the **Capture** clash is triggered.
- The **enemy Keep is destroyed** and returned to its owner's **Supply**.
- You immediately build a **Keep** of your own color on the Tile.
- **3 attacking Troops** are sent to the **Cemetery**.
- **6 attacking Troops** are returned to your **Supply**.

The Rearguard Rule – If you move more Troops than necessary for a clash, the remaining units form the **Rearguard**. Their behavior depends on the action being performed:

1. **Concentration:** The Rearguard continues its movement toward the Command Tile.
2. **Dispersion:** The Rearguard must stop on the Tile where the clash occurred.

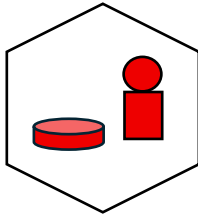
9.2.2. Controlling a Tile

A Tile is considered **controlled** by a **color** if that color has **strictly more Knights** on the Tile than any other individual enemy color.

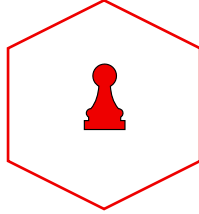
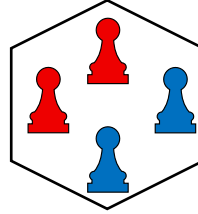
- **Ties or Absence:** If no color has a **majority**, or if there are no Knights present, the Tile is considered **uncontrolled**.
- **Note:** Barons, Troops, and Keeps never factor into the calculation for controlling a Tile; **only Knights** are taken into account.
- **Note:** "Controlling a Tile" can block or limit the abilities of a "Command Tile," as explained in §9.2.3.

- **Examples of Tile Control:**

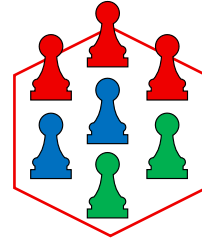
- **1 Red Knight:** Controlled by the **Red side**.
- **2 Red vs. 2 Blue:** Tie → **no control**.
- **3 Red vs. 2 Blue vs. 2 Green:** Red majority → controlled by the **Red side**.



No Control

Controlled by **Red**

No Control

Controlled by **Red**

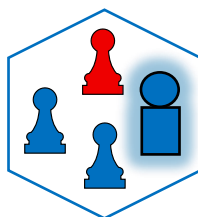
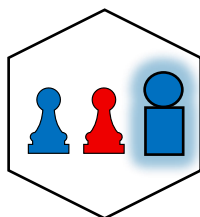
9.2.3. Command Tile

To play any **Troop Action card**, you must **designate** a **Command Tile**. There are three types of Command Tiles, each offering different capabilities:

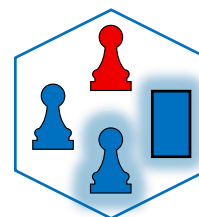
	Baron	A Tile with your Baron can: Recruit , Build , Concentrate , and Disperse .
	Keep + Knight	A Tile with one of your Keeps and one of your Knights can: Recruit , Concentrate , and Disperse .
	Keep	A Tile with only one of your Keeps can: Concentrate and Disperse .

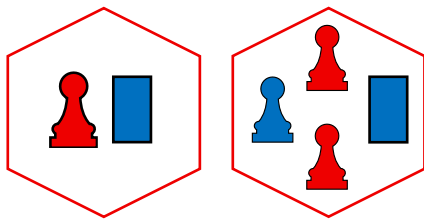
Knight Control Restrictions:

- You **cannot designate** a **Command Tile** if it is **controlled** (see §9.2.2) by **enemy Knights**. Your Command Tile must be either uncontrolled or controlled by your own Knights.
- The "**Keep + Knight**" Command Tile loses some of its capabilities if **enemy Knights** are present and **your Knights do not hold a majority** (i.e., they are at a tie, see §9.2.2). In this situation, your Knights are considered engaged in a standoff and **cannot proceed** with the **recruitment** of **Troops**.

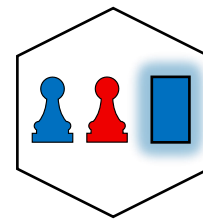


Blue Baron Command Tiles

Blue Keep + Knight
Command Tile



Tiles **Controlled** by **Red**;
Command lost by **Blue**

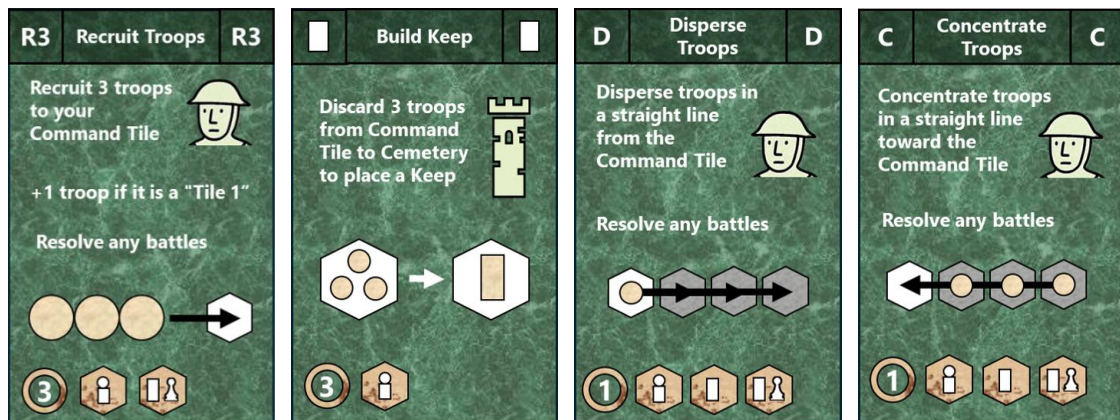


Blue Keep Command Tile

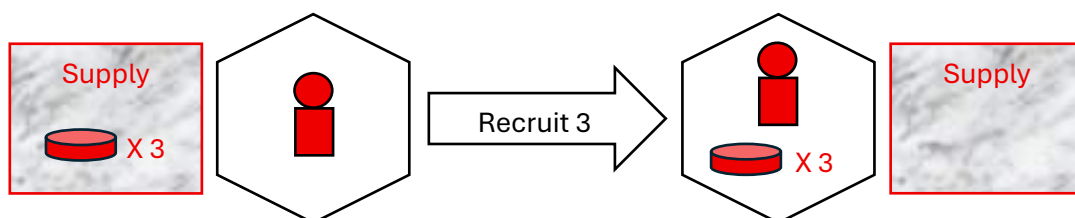
9.3. Troop Action Cards

Now that you are familiar with the mechanics of clashes, Tile control, and Command Tiles (see §9.2), you are ready to explore the effects of Troop Action cards.

The authorized Command Tiles for each card are indicated by **hexagonal icons** at the bottom of the Action card (see figure below).



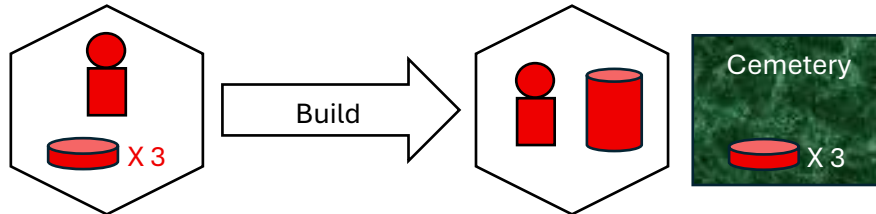
- **Recruit Troops 3** – On the designated Command Tile, recruit **3 Troops** taken from your supply. If the Command Tile is a **1-point Tile (Grey)**, you gain a **bonus of 1 Troop** (*representing a poor land where it is easy to find recruits*). Furthermore:
 - If your supply is not empty but does not contain enough Troops, recruit as many as possible. If your supply is completely empty, you cannot play this card.
 - **Enemy Troops** occupying your Command Tile **do not block** recruitment. However, your newly recruited Troops must **clash with them immediately** (see §9.2.1).



- **Recruit Troops 2** – Identical to "Recruit Troops 3," but you recruit only **2 Troops** (plus any potential terrain bonus).
- **Recruit Troops 1** – Identical to "Recruit Troops 3," but you recruit only **1 Troop** (plus any potential terrain bonus).

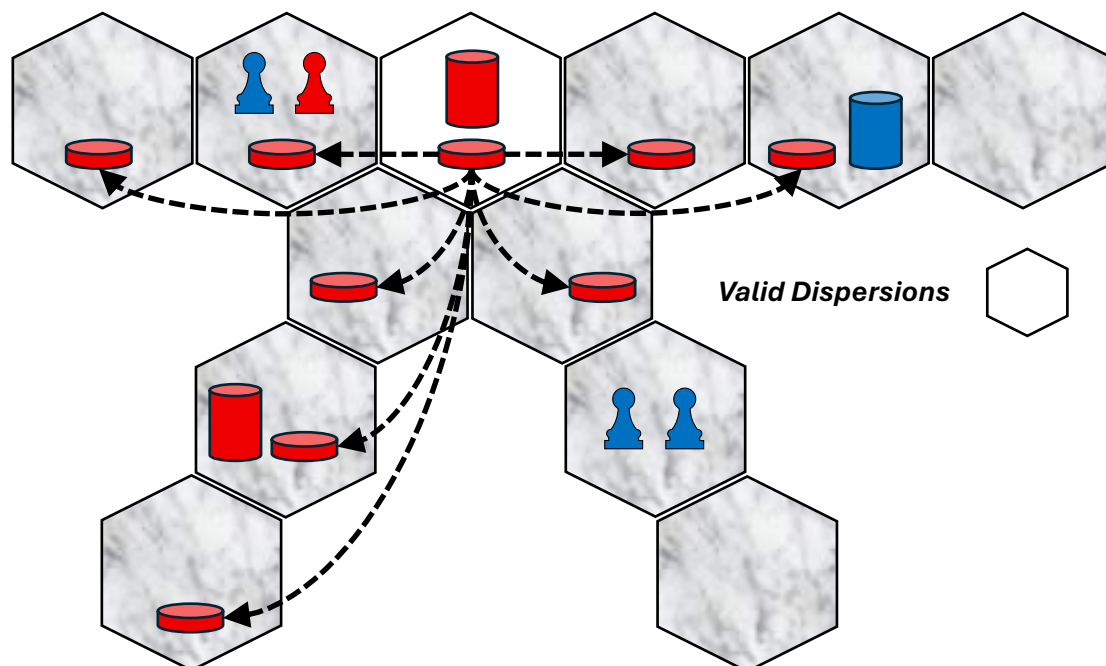
- **Build Keep** – Discard **3 Troops** from the designated Command Tile to the **Cemetery** and place a **Keep** on that Tile. **Constraints:**

- A **Tile** may be occupied by **only one Keep**.
- **Two Keeps**, whether allied or enemy, **must not be adjacent** to each other.

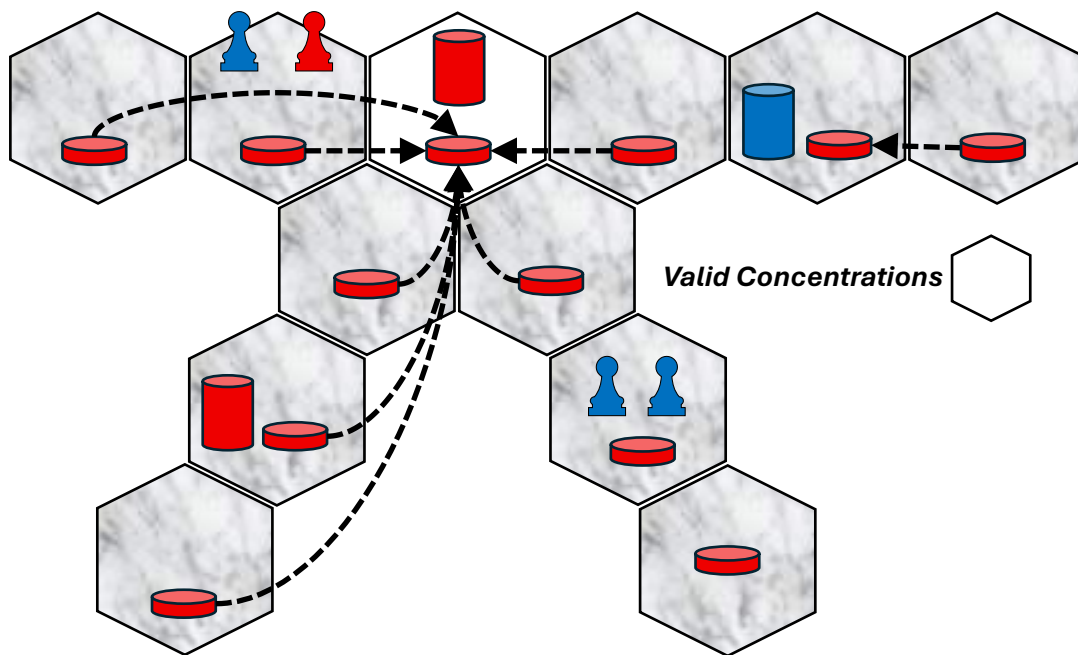


- **Disperse Troops** – From the designated Command Tile, move some or all of your Troops:

- Each Troop moves in a **straight line** in its own direction, as far as you choose.
- A Troop may not cross or occupy a **Mountain Tile** or a **Tile controlled by enemy Knights** (see §9.2.2).
- A Troop must stop to **resolve** any Troop or enemy Keep **clash** (see §9.2.1).
- A Troop must stop when entering a Tile with an **enemy Keep**, even if no clash is triggered. If no clash occurs during this action, this Troop may be concentrated or dispersed during a future action.

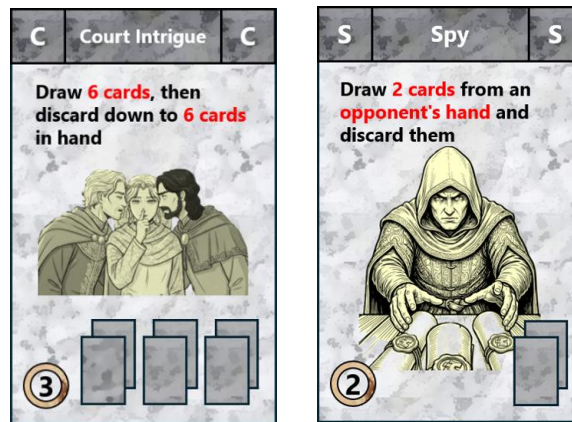


- **Concentrate Troops** – Toward the designated Command Tile, move some or all of your Troops that are aligned with said Command Tile:
 - Same rules as "Disperse Troops," but with the movement direction reversed. Specific rules are detailed below.
 - Each Troop moves in a straight line, **as close as possible to the Command Tile**. Any clashes triggered along the way are resolved immediately (see §9.2.1).
 - The concentration **order cannot pass through** a **Mountain Tile** or a **Tile controlled by enemy Knights** (see §9.2.2). Consequently, your Troops located on or beyond a Tile controlled by an opponent cannot be concentrated.



9.4. Hand Action Cards

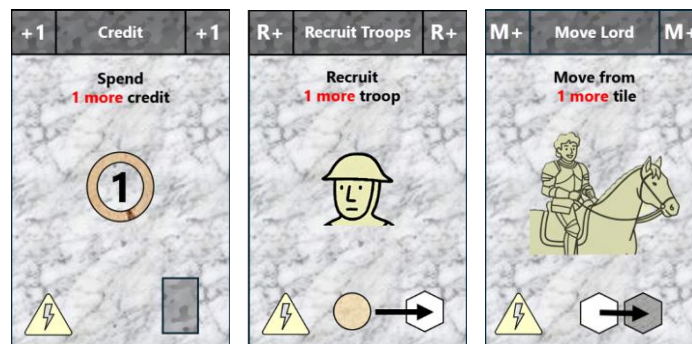
Here are the Action cards that affect your hand or an opponent's hand:



- **Court Intrigue (rare)** – After discarding "Court Intrigue", you first add **6 cards** to your hand from your deck. Then, you **discard** cards to keep only 6 in hand. **At the end of the "Court Intrigue" Action, you have 6 cards in hand, so you do not draw anything during the "Reinforce" phase.**
- **Spy (rare)** – Choose an **opponent**. Draw **2 cards at random** from their hand. **Reveal** these 2 cards **to all players** before discarding them. The other cards are placed in your **opponent's discard pile**.

10. The Effect Cards

Here are the Effect cards that act independently or in association with Action cards.



An Effect card is identifiable by the lightning bolt in the bottom left corner.

- **Additional Credit:**
 - This Effect card is played alone, during the Plan phase of Option A.
 - This Effect card increases by 1 credit the amount available to play your Action cards during this turn.

- **Additional Recruitment:**

- This Effect card is played in association with a "Recruit Troops" Action card (regardless of its value).
- This Effect card increases by 1 the number of Troops recruited by the Action card.

- **Additional Movement:**

- This Effect card is played in association with a "Move Lord" Action card (regardless of its value).
- This Effect card increases the maximum movement distance by 1 Tile.

11. Reference Sheet

